

Sahal Shafiq

Web Developer



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Developer PROFILE

Accomplished Web Developer and SEO Specialist with over 5 years of comprehensive experience in full-stack web development, Custom WordPress solutions, and advanced search engine optimization. Expert in building scalable, business-driven websites with a strong focus on UI/UX excellence, performance optimization, and organic search visibility. Proven track record of delivering custom themes, plugins, complex eCommerce systems, and SEO-optimized websites for clients across real estate, finance, banking, and eCommerce sectors. Combines technical web development expertise with strategic SEO implementation (On-Page, Off-Page, Technical, and Local SEO) to drive measurable business results including increased traffic, improved rankings, and higher conversion rates. Skilled in HTML5/CSS3/JavaScript/Nodejs/NextJs, REST API integrations, automated workflows, and delivering pixel-perfect implementations from design to deployment with maximum search engine performance.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Jan 2023 – Aug 2025 **SEO Specialist:** Self-Employed / Client Projects
Remote, Pakistan

- Executed comprehensive **SEO strategies across 25+ client websites**, increasing organic traffic by 150-300%.
- Performed **technical SEO audits** and implemented Core Web Vitals optimization achieving 90+ PageSpeed scores.
- Built high-quality backlink profiles through digital PR, guest posting, and strategic outreach campaigns.
- Implemented **Schema markup (JSON-LD)** for products, articles, and local businesses to enhance rich snippets.
- Optimized **Google My Business profiles and local citations** for multi-location businesses.
- Managed Google Analytics 4, Search Console, and Tag Manager for comprehensive performance tracking.
- Conducted keyword research using SEMrush and Ahrefs to inform content strategy and site architecture.

Dec 2022 – Aug 2025 **Senior Web Developer:** Self-Employed / Client Projects
Remote, Pakistan

- Developed **custom WordPress themes** from scratch using **PHP, HTML5, CSS3/SCSS, and JavaScript ES6+**.
- Built **custom plugins with OOP PHP architecture for CPTs**, taxonomies, and admin functionality.
- Created **ACF Blocks using block.json** and PHP render callbacks for dynamic content sections.
- Integrated REST API endpoints for third-party services and headless WordPress implementations.
- Implemented **WooCommerce customizations through template** overrides, hooks, and filters.
- Optimized database queries using **WP_Query, \$wpdb, and custom SQL** for performance improvements.
- Converted Figma/Adobe XD designs into pixel-perfect responsive layouts with custom CSS Grid and Flexbox.
- Implemented caching strategies (**Redis, object caching**) and **CDN** integration reducing load times by 60%.
- Added SEO-friendly URL structures, XML sitemaps, and robots.txt optimization for better indexing.
- Used Git version control with feature branching and pull request workflows for team collaboration.

Jan 2021 – Nov 2022
Remote, Pakistan, UK,
USA & Australia

Full Stack Web Developer: Freelance / Contract-Based

- Built **custom WordPress** sites using starter themes (Underscores, Sage) with **Blade templating and Laravel Mix**.
- Created **AJAX-powered search filters using jQuery** and WordPress AJAX handlers for real-time results.
- Developed **ACF Flexible Content layouts** with repeater fields for modular page building.
- Integrated payment gateways (Stripe, PayPal) into WooCommerce with custom checkout flows.
- Built a **rental listing platform with custom taxonomies**, meta queries, and geolocation-based search.
- Implemented custom user registration and login systems with role-based access control.
- Created custom admin dashboards using React and WordPress REST API for data visualization.
- Optimized images with lazy loading, WebP conversion, and responsive srcset attributes.
- Implemented basic on-page SEO including meta tags, Open Graph, and Twitter Card markup.
- Used **Gulp/Webpack** for asset compilation, minification, and build automation.

Mar 2019 – Dec 2020
Remote, Pakistan, UK,
USA & Australia

Junior Web Developer: Freelance / Remote

- Developed responsive WordPress websites using Elementor Pro with custom CSS and mobile-first design.
- Implemented JavaScript animations and interactive elements using vanilla JS and jQuery libraries.
- Created child themes for popular WordPress themes (Astra, GeneratePress) with custom modifications.
- Optimized website forms using Contact Form 7 and Gravity Forms with conditional logic.
- Performed cross-browser testing and bug fixing across Chrome, Firefox, Safari, and Edge.
- Implemented basic SEO practices including title tags, meta descriptions, and heading hierarchy.
- Assisted in website migrations from shared hosting to VPS with minimal downtime.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science (BSc) - Software Engineering (Final Year)

Jan 2023 – Present

Virtual University of Pakistan

- Focusing on Full Stack Development and Database Systems
- Specializing in Python for Machine Learning applications
- Coursework in Software Architecture, Algorithms, and Data Structures

Diploma in Web Development

2018 – 2019

Udemy (Online Learning Platform)

- Covered HTML5, CSS3, JavaScript ES6+, and WordPress Development
- Introduction to React fundamentals and modern JavaScript frameworks
- Practical projects in responsive design and web application development

TECHNICAL SKILLS

1. HTML5, CSS3, SCSS & Responsive Design
2. JavaScript ES6+, jQuery & AJAX
3. PHP (OOP), MySQL & Database Management
4. React.js & Modern JavaScript Frameworks
5. WordPress Theme & Plugin Development
6. Advanced Custom Fields (ACF Pro)
7. Gutenberg Block Development
8. WooCommerce Development & Customization
9. REST API Development & Integration
10. MS Office (Word, Excel, PowerPoint & Power BI)

1. On-Page SEO & Content Optimization
2. Technical SEO & Site Audits
3. Off-Page SEO & Link Building
4. Local SEO & Google My Business
5. Schema Markup & Structured Data
6. Git, GitHub & Version Control
7. Elementor Pro & Page Builders
8. Figma, Adobe XD & UI/UX Design
9. Google Analytics 4 & Search Console
10. SEMrush, Ahrefs & SEO Tools
11. Performance Optimization & Caching

LANGUAGES

English

Full Professional
Proficiency

Urdu

Native Proficiency

CORE COMPETENCIES

1. Web Development (Custom, WordPress, Front-End, Backend) 2. SEO (General, Technical, Performance) 3. eCommerce (WooCommerce) 4. Technical (API, Database, Performance) 4. Design (UI/UX, Responsive, Mobile) 5. Professional (Client Relations, Project Management, Agile)